

After about a week, I gradually found that, having a notebook, I wanted to surf in bed as well. Up to that time I used to unplug the LAN cable from my PC and use my notebook on my PC table, but after a while, this exercise became quite an annoyance. It became quite obvious that I would need a

wireless router. Initially, I had a few reservations about what sort of router I'd need. The possibility of signal attenuation reared its ugly head; although my place is fairly small, I was still concerned because the router would need to be placed in my hall near my PC and there is no direct line of sight to the bedroom, especially the spot where notebook is typically used. I didn't need a high-end router, but I definitely wanted something that would work properly with this set-up.

Now Wi-Fi routers aren't something you can buy from malls, so after some extensive reading up on models available, I took a Friday off from office and caught an 11 am local train to Lamington Road. Once there, I made my way to the first big hardware shop I spotted and enquired about routers. He suggested an ADSL router, which I did not want. For one, I have a LAN-based internet connection and most ISPs these days prefer this over the older RJ11 (telephonic) connect. An ADSL router basically has a modem inbuilt into it and features both RJ45 (WAN) and RJ11 connects. Since I was sure I would never be using an RJ11-based ISP, it didn't make sense to shell more for an unused feature. Explaining to this guy proved futile, since he was convinced that an ADSL router is faster than a regular router.

If you are shopping for a Wi-Fi router, please consider an 802.11n one. Wireless N is the latest protocol, supporting greater speed, better range and coverage over the previous standard Wireless G or 801.11g. The latest craze seems to be dual-band routers. These routers operate on a 5 GHz frequency as well as the de facto 2.4 GHz band. Since each band offers a particular bandwidth, the effective bandwidth doubles, meaning greater throughput. Although this is pretty useless for most of us since our internet speeds are a



Linksys Router